

Checklist

Engineering Executive: Engineering Org Meetings

Foundations: WHY You're Running Meetings

- ☐ Clear purpose for each meeting (decision, review, development, alignment, Q&A)
- ☐ Meetings fill communication gaps (do not default to them)
- ☐ Used to:
 - ☐ Distribute context
 - ☐ Communicate culture
 - ☐ Surface concerns
- ☐ Willing to iterate, pause, or cancel low-value meetings

Core Meeting CADENCE

Weekly TEAM Meetings

- ☐ Each manager meets weekly with their direct team
- ☐ Clear agenda
- ☐ Focused on execution and alignment
- ☐ Tight, well-run, and ends on time

Weekly Engineering LEADERSHIP Meeting

- ☐ Includes all direct reports

- ☐ May include Recruiting, People, and Finance partners
- ☐ Running, shared agenda doc
- ☐ Prioritized topics before the meeting starts
- ☐ Used as a working session (not status theater)
- ☐ Builds “first team” mindset among leaders
- ☐ Meets weekly (unless org is very small)

Weekly TECH SPEC Review

- ☐ Anchored to a concise written document
- ☐ Reading is a prerequisite (or reading time built in)
- ☐ Discussion-driven (not the author presenting slides)
- ☐ Feedback-centered
- ☐ Clear process for getting specs scheduled
- ☐ Dedicated meeting owner
- ☐ First-time facilitators get a practice run

Weekly INCIDENT Review

- ☐ Anchored to the written incident write-up
- ☐ Focus on learning, not blame
- ☐ Discussion over the presentation
- ☐ Clear scheduling process
- ☐ Owned by a responsible leader
- ☐ Attendance by senior engineering leadership

Monthly Engineering MANAGERS Meeting

- ☐ All engineering managers attend
- ☐ Format:
 - ☐ 1-minute updates (working on / excited about / worried about)
 - ☐ Development topic presentation (~30 min)
 - ☐ Open Q&A

- ☐ Focused on craft and leadership development
- ☐ Adjusted for pressing issues when needed

Monthly STAFF+ Engineers Meeting

- ☐ All Staff+ engineers attend
- ☐ Similar development format as managers session
- ☐ Managers generally excluded
- ☐ Focused on technical leadership growth

Monthly Engineering Q&A

- ☐ 60 minutes
- ☐ Start with new hire intros
- ☐ Short intro message from Head of Eng
- ☐ The majority of the time is reserved for Q&A
- ☐ “No questions off limits” tone
- ☐ Tool supports:
 - ☐ Pre-submitted questions
 - ☐ Upvoting
 - ☐ Anonymous questions
- ☐ Reminder sent 1 hour before the session
- ☐ Rotate times across time zones if needed
- ☐ Avoid recording (unless necessary)
- ☐ Use to:
 - ☐ Surface concerns
 - ☐ Test trust
 - ☐ Highlight contributors

Additional High-Value Meetings

1:1 Meetings

- ☐ Weekly with direct reports
- ☐ Regular cadence with key peers
- ☐ Flexible duration (30–60 mins)
- ☐ Focused on support, growth, and alignment

Skip-Level Meetings

- ☐ Fixed time budget (e.g., 1–2 hrs/week)
- ☐ Structured format (group or 1:1)
- ☐ Don't crowd out core work

Execution Review (Cross-Functional)

- ☐ Weekly or monthly cadence
- ☐ Tracks execution and resolves blockers
- ☐ Cross-functional (not Eng-only)
- ☐ Clear owners and follow-ups

Show-and-Tells / Demos

- ☐ Regular cadence (weekly–monthly)
- ☐ Celebrate work
- ☐ Reinforce culture and values

Tech Talks / Learning Sessions

- ☐ Reading groups or knowledge sharing
- ☐ Encourages collective learning

Engineering All-Hands

- ☐ Clear format (roadmap/demo/culture)
- ☐ Aligned with company-wide meetings
- ☐ Not duplicative of the company all-hands

Scaling Guidelines

- ☐ Split meetings when participant context diverges
- ☐ Keep developmental sessions ≤ 10 active participants
- ☐ Push meetings down a layer if the org grows too large
- ☐ Maintain org-wide Q&A as a single shared forum
- ☐ Don't split prematurely due to 1-2 difficult participants
- ☐ Hold participants accountable for behavior
- ☐ Optimize for engagement, not headcount

Ownership & Leadership

- ☐ Clear the meeting owner for each recurring session
- ☐ The leader shows up consistently
- ☐ Executive models behavior expected from others
- ☐ Coordination support (EA/program manager)
- ☐ Even if not leading, the executive remains accountable for quality

Quality Bar

For every meeting, ask:

- ☐ Is it anchored to a written document?
- ☐ Is discussion prioritized over presentation?
- ☐ Are the right people in the room?
- ☐ Is there a clear output (decision, alignment, learning)?
- ☐ Would we cancel this if it stopped adding value?